GST 312: PEACE AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Complete Master Study Summary — Chapters 1 to 12

Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka (UNIZIK)

CHAPTER ONE: CONCEPTUAL ISSUES IN PEACE AND CONFLICT STUDIES

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1. CONCEPT AND PERSPECTIVES ON CONFLICT

Etymology of Conflict: Derived from the Latin word *confligere*, which literally translates to **"to strike together"**.

Key Definitions of Conflict

Conflict lacks a single universal definition, but major scholars have defined it through specific analytical dimensions:

Scholar / Perspective	Core Definition & Key Conceptualization
Lewis Coser 1956	Defined conflict as a contest over values and claims to scarce status, power, and resources, in which the aims of the conflicting parties are to neutralize, injure, or eliminate their opponents.
Johan Galtung *(cited in Ercoşkun, 2021)*	Conceptualized conflict as a dynamic process in which structures, attitudes, and behaviors constantly change and mutually influence one another.
Sociologists	View conflict as opposition among social entities directed directly against one another.
Quincy Wright 1957	Defined conflict as a form of relationship between two entities with similar capacities, occurring when two systems of action make decisions so inconsistent that both cannot be implemented simultaneously.
Snyder 1957	Identified four essential conditions: (1) existence of 2+ parties, (2) resource/ position scarcity, (3) behavior designed to hurt/injure, and (4) mutually opposed goals.
Francis 2006	Defined conflict as the pursuit of incompatible interests and goals by different groups.
Swanstrom & Weissmann 2005	Defined conflict as a situation where two or more parties strive to acquire the same scarce resources at the exact same time.

Nature and Life Cycle of Conflict

- **Ubiquity & Intrinsic Nature:** Conflict is a permanent, natural, and unavoidable feature of human existence (Francis, 2006). Because human beings are social creatures who constantly interact, differences in goals, values, and perceptions will inevitably generate disagreement.

- **Conflict Life Cycle Model (Swanstrom & Weissmann, 2005 ; Lund, 1996):**
  - **5 Levels of Intensity:** Stable peace → Unstable peace → Open conflict → Crisis → War.
  - **2 Phases:** Escalation Phase and De-escalation Phase.
  - **3 Duration Stages:** Early-stage, Mid-stage, and Late-stage.

Core Components of Conflict Analysis

- **Actors in Conflict:** The identifiable units that initiate, prosecute, and determine the outcome of a conflict (Bercovitch et al., 2008). These include sovereign states, communal groups, ethnic/religious groups, organisations, or individuals.
- **Issues in Conflict:** The grievances motivating the dispute:
  - *Conflicted Evaluation:* Disagreement over **means** (how to achieve a goal, despite agreeing on the end) versus disagreement over **ends** (disagreeing on the actual outcome/want).
  - *Differential Rewards:* Situations structured as a **zero-sum game**, where the reward for one actor translates directly into a punishment or loss for the other.
  - *Contending Content:* Tangible issues (land, mineral resources, territory) or intangible issues (ideology, recognition, status).
- **Conflict Environment:** The social context within which conflict takes place:
  - *Structured Environment:* Governed by prescribed norms, rules, and established institutions; conflict here is far easier to manage and resolve.
  - *Unstructured Environment:* Characterized by chaos, breakdown, or absence of institutional norms; actors frequently resort to force to enforce their demands.

2. CONCEPT AND DIMENSIONS OF VIOLENCE

> **Etymology of Violence:** Traced to the German word *Gewalt*, meaning "to have strength," "to have power," "to have something at one's disposal," or "to control something".

Johan Galtung's Formulation of Violence

Norwegian sociologist Johan Galtung (1969) provided the foundational conceptual framework for studying violence, defining it as *"the cause of the difference between the potential and the actual, between what could have been and what is."*

> **Galtung's Example of Structural Violence**
>
> If a person died of tuberculosis in the 18th century, it was not violence because medical knowledge was lacking (the potential matched the actual). However, if someone dies of tuberculosis today despite available medical treatments, violence is present because society failed to deliver achievable potential.

Galtung's Three Dimensions of Violence (Triangle / Iceberg Model)

Dimension	Categorization	Characteristics & Examples
Direct / Personal Violence	**EVENT** (Visible Tip)	Involves a clear, identifiable actor committing physical acts that cause bodily harm, injury, or death (e.g., assault, murder, war, terrorism).
Indirect / Structural Violence	**PROCESS** (Invisible Base)	Violence built into political, social, and economic systems and structures. Manifests as systemic inequality, exclusion, poverty, and denial of basic human needs.
Cultural / Symbolic Violence	**PERMANENCE** (Invisible Substratum)	Aspects of culture—such as religion, language, art, ideology, or science—used to justify, legitimize, or make direct and structural violence appear normal or acceptable.

3. CONCEPT AND PERSPECTIVES ON PEACE

> **Etymology of Peace:** Derived from the Anglo-French word *pes* and Old French word *pias*, meaning "peace, reconciliation, silence, agreement".

Galtung's Three Conceptualizations of Peace

1. **Peace as Stability or Equilibrium:** Internal psychological tranquility of an individual, or societal "law and order" maintained through predictable social rules—even if enforced by coercion or force.
2. **Negative Peace:** The absence of physical war, direct combat, and organized collective violence.
3. **Positive Peace:** The presence of structural justice, social equality, cooperation, and integration between human groups.

Four Broad Perspectives on Peace

- **Philosophical Perspective:** Peace as a natural state of divine tranquility (e.g., St. Augustine's *City of God* vs. *City of Man*; Rousseau's peaceful state of nature prior to the introduction of private property).
- **Sociological Perspective:** A state of social harmony where individuals meet their needs and expectations without role conflicts or social antagonisms (structural functionalism).
- **Political Perspective:** Order established through political structures and norms where the state holds a monopoly over the legitimate use of force (traced historically to the **1648** Treaty of Westphalia).
- **Process Perspective (Ibeanu, 2006):** Peace viewed not as a static state, but as a continuous work-in-progress involving peacekeeping, peace enforcement, peacemaking, and peacebuilding.

4. CONCEPT AND EVOLUTION OF PEACEBUILDING

Concept of Peacebuilding

The term was popularized globally in **1992** by former UN Secretary-General **Boutros Boutros-Ghali** in his benchmark report, *An Agenda for Peace*.

- **Pre-Conflict Peacebuilding:** Measures applied before conflict escalates into violence (e.g., demilitarization, control of small arms, judicial and electoral reforms).
- **Post-Conflict Peacebuilding:** Multidimensional strategies aimed at consolidating peace, promoting reconciliation, and rebuilding infrastructure to prevent a relapse into war.

Four Epochs in the Evolution of Peacebuilding

Epoch & Timeline	Key Characteristics & Focus Areas
1. Multidimensional Peacekeeping 1989 – 1999	Expansion of traditional military peacekeeping to include vital civilian roles: human rights monitoring, election supervision, policing reform, and disarmament.
2. Peacebuilding as Statebuilding 1999 – 2005	Focus on rebuilding and strengthening state institutions as the bedrock for peace (e.g., UN direct administrative missions in Kosovo and East Timor).
3. UN Peacebuilding Architecture (PBA) 2005 – 2009	Established following the 2004 High-Level Panel Report and 2005 World Summit to bridge policy and operational gaps within the UN peacebuilding machinery.
4. Nationally-Owned Peacebuilding 2009 – 2014	Shift towards local ownership, civil society participation, and context-sensitive approaches in response to criticisms of top-down liberal statebuilding interventions.

CHAPTER TWO: TYPES OF CONFLICTS

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1. INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

- **Inevitability of Conflict:** Conflict is an unavoidable feature of human society arising when individuals, groups, or nations perceive differences in goals, values, interests, or needs.
- **Dual Nature of Conflict:** While often associated with destruction, when managed constructively, conflict stimulates dialogue, innovation, and social transformation.
- **Significance in Multi-Ethnic Societies:** In pluralistic states like Nigeria, unmanaged conflicts threaten national integration, economic growth, and political stability.

2. ETHNIC CONFLICT

Meaning & Nature

Refers to disputes or violence between distinct ethnic groups based on perceived cultural, religious, or linguistic differences (Osaghae & Suberu, 2005). Ethnic conflicts are deeply rooted in identity and collective memory, making them protracted and susceptible to political exploitation.

Key Causes & Scholars

- **Resource Competition & Dominance:** Struggles over state resources and political domination (Horowitz, 2000). In Nigeria, major ethnic dominance (Hausa-Fulani, Yoruba, Igbo) fosters marginalization felt by minor ethnic groups, driving autonomy agitators (Osaghae & Suberu, 2005).
- **Colonial Legacies:** Arbitrary colonial borders and discriminatory divide-and-rule policies (Gurr, 1993 ; Fearon & Laitin, 2003). A classic global example includes colonial favoritism reinforcing ethnic rivalry prior to the Rwandan genocide.
- **Identity Politics:** Elites manipulating ethnic sentiments for electoral advantage.

Policy Responses & Management Mechanisms

- **Institutional Reforms (Lijphart, 1977):** Adoption of **federalism**, **power-sharing**, **affirmative action policies**, state creation, revenue-sharing, and the **Federal Character Principle** to ensure equitable representation.
- **Conflict Transformation:** Promoting civic education, deconstructing stereotypes, inter-group dialogue, and justice frameworks like South Africa's Truth and Reconciliation Commission.

3. RELIGIOUS CONFLICT

Meaning & Manifestation

Disputes or violence resulting from differences in faith, doctrines, beliefs, and practices among groups in multi-religious societies. Manifests as communal clashes, violent extremism, or discrimination.

Key Causes & Timeline / Examples

- **Exclusivist Dogma (Juergensmeyer, 2003):** Claims by one group of possessing absolute religious truth, delegitimizing others.

- **Politicization of Faith (Osagie, 2007):** Politicians manipulating religious identities to gain support or distract from governance failures.
- **Socioeconomic Deprivation (Falola, 1998):** Poverty and youth unemployment fueling recruitment into violent extremist groups like **Boko Haram** in Northern Nigeria.
- **Historical Narratives & Sharia Clashes (Salawu, 2010):** Colonial divide-and-rule legacy and friction over legal systems, such as resistance to Sharia law implementation in Northern Nigeria.

Policy Responses

- Promoting religious literacy, interfaith dialogue, and tolerance through education and media (Onapajo, 2016).
- Maintaining constitutional religious freedom, ensuring security force impartiality, and addressing structural poverty.

4. ECONOMIC CONFLICT

Meaning & Causes

Disputes stemming from competition over scarce economic resources (land, employment, wealth, development). Driven by elite resource capture, corruption, inequality, and weak governance structures (Akinola, 2021).

Major Timeline Events & Examples

- **Niger Delta Conflict (Collier & Hoeffler, 2004):** Violent revolt by oil-producing local communities against state and multinational oil companies due to environmental degradation and revenue exclusion.
- **Youth Unemployment & Thuggery (Obadare, 2010):** Economic frustration driving youth toward violent groups ("Area Boys"), political thuggery, or cybercrime syndicates ("Yahoo-Yahoo").
- **COVID-19 Palliative Looting 2020/2021 (Akinola, 2021):** Allegations of inequitable distribution of palliatives in Nigeria triggering public outrage and widespread warehouse looting.

Policy Responses

- Implementing derivation principles, progressive taxation, transparent public spending, job creation, and social safety nets (Stiglitz, 2012).

5. GEO-POLITICAL CONFLICT

Meaning & Key Causes

Disputes over political authority, territorial claims, strategic dominance, or geographical resources between nations or regions. Driven by power rotation struggles, perceived regional marginalization, unequal infrastructure development, boundary disputes, resource access, and census politicization (Suberu, 2001 ; Mustapha, 2007).

Global & Regional Examples / Timelines

- **Israel-Palestine Conflict (Smith, 2010):** Protracted geopolitical dispute over contested territory, nationalist claims, and religious symbols.
- **Bakassi Peninsula Dispute:** Territorial boundary dispute between Nigeria and Cameroon leading to recurrent military tensions and international mediation.

- **Nile River Waters Struggle (Cascão & Zeitoun, 2010):** Geopolitical competition over Nile water access among Egypt, Ethiopia, and Sudan.
- **South China Sea Claims:** China's historical territory claims creating maritime and diplomatic friction with neighboring Asian states.
- **Syrian Conflict Superpower Intervention (Phillips, 2016):** Strategic proxy intervention by external powers (US, Russia, Iran) escalating internal conflicts.
- **Nigerian Zonal Struggles:** Tensions among Nigeria's six geopolitical zones over presidential power rotation, federal appointments, and state creation.

Policy Responses & Institutional Interventions

- **Domestic Policies:** Zoning arrangements, federal character enforcement, state creation, and development bodies like the **Niger Delta Development Commission (NDDC)**.
- **International & Regional Bodies (Bellamy & Williams, 2010):** Mediation by the United Nations (UN), International Court of Justice (ICJ), ECOWAS, and NATO; early warning systems and joint border development.

CHAPTER THREE: THEORIES OF CONFLICT

By Chidubem Michael Nwoye (Institute for Peace, Security and Development Studies - IPSDS, Nnamdi Azikiwe University)

1. INTRODUCTION & NATURE OF THEORY

- **Definition of Theory:** A conceptual framework depicting real-world phenomena through assumed principles (Daramola, 2003). Theories provide explanation, prediction, and systematic analysis to eliminate conflict-related problems (Cohen, 1968 ; Rychlak, 1968).
- **4 Major Types of Theory in Literature:**
  - *Analytical Theories:* Logical statements defining characteristics; conflict theories primarily belong here.
  - *Normative Theories:* Describe best possible conditions established/maintained by humans.
  - *Scientific Theories:* Focus on universal relationships between events.
  - *Metaphysical Theories:* Guide human science research though impossible to test directly.

2. FIVE MAIN THEORIES OF CONFLICT

1. Structural Conflict Theory

Explains that conflict results from how societies organize themselves, producing inequality, injustice, and political exclusion.

- **Radical Structuralism (Marxist Thought):** Emphasizes economic structures and class struggle between the owners of production (**bourgeoisie**) and labor workers (**proletariat**). Exploitation leads to inevitable social change and struggle.
- **Liberal Structuralism (Johan Galtung, Marc Ross):** Focuses on societal constructs causing inequality. Galtung (1990) introduced **negative peace** (absence of direct violence) and **positive peace** (absence of structural violence and presence of social justice).
- **Key Insights:** Scarborough (1998) notes that benefiting one group while disadvantaging another creates explosive conflict. Ross (1993) highlights economic and political discrimination. Anifowose (1982) applies this to Nigerian politics, showing how federal institutional disparities generate violence (e.g., Yoruba and Tiv cases).

2. Realist Theory of Conflict

Attributes conflict to inherent flaws in human nature, such as selfishness, power thirst, and competitive survival in a world of scarce resources.

- **Three Elements of Realism:**
  - *Descriptive Realism:* Views the world as an arena of inevitable conflict.
  - *Explanatory Realism:* Assumes genetic/inherent defects drive human negative behavior (Koestler, 1967).
  - *Prescriptive Realism:* Asserts decision-makers must defend interests by any necessary means without moral restriction.

- **Hans Morgenthau (1973):** Leading realist thinker (*Politics among Nations*). Defined politics as a struggle for power where conflict is managed rather than eliminated. Realists view politics as a **zero-sum game** where compromise is hard to attain.

3. Frustration-Aggression Theory

Posits that violent behavior occurs as a direct result of frustrated goal-attainment when legitimate expectations are blocked.

- **Origins & Scholars:** Developed by John Dollard et al. (1939) and expanded by Leonard Berkowitz (1962).
- **Relative Deprivation Theory (Ted Robert Gurr, 1970):** Violence occurs when there is a wide gap between expectations and actual achievements. Davies (1962) emphasizes the "want-get ratio".
- **Nigerian Context (Anifowose, 1982):** Demonstrates how blocked political/economic aspirations among ethnic groups translate into aggressive violent responses. Yates (1962) notes frustration creates conditions making aggression highly probable.

4. Neo-Realism (Structural Realism)

Evolves classical realism by shifting focus from human nature to **systemic structural factors** and international anarchy.

- **Anarchical System & Self-Help:** In the absence of a supreme governing authority, actors must rely on self-help for survival (Morgenthau, 1973).
- **Security Dilemma (Brown, 1996):** Security measures taken by one actor increase insecurity in others, driving arms races and escalation even without aggressive intent. Applied to internal state collapse where weak central government leads ethnic groups to adopt self-help measures.

5. Psycho-Cultural Theory of Conflict

Investigates how cultural narratives, collective memory, and ingrained psychological factors combine to drive group conflict.

Component (Ross, 1993)	Description & Function
Collective Narrative Systems	Culturally built frameworks helping social groups interpret events and prescribe honorable conduct.
Memorial Repertoires	Curated generational memories of past victories and catastrophes warning of current threats.
Psychological Steadiness	Individual anxiety driven toward security offered by culturally specified identities.
Material & Visual Symbols	Use of flags, anthems, and martyr figures to rally the in-group against the out-group.

- **Resolution Requirements (Kelman, 1993):** Sustainable peace requires going beyond structural/material solutions to address deep identity, cultural sensitivity, and psychological needs.

3. SYNTHESIS AND INTEGRATION

No single theory fully explains complex conflicts. Structural factors create the context, psycho-cultural factors determine how groups interpret that context, and competition over scarce resources (realism) triggers active disputes.

Multi-Theoretical Integration & Conclusion of Chapter 3

Ross (1993) emphasizes that while structural identification is accurate most of the time, **single-cause explanations lead to incomplete understanding and potential errors**. Modern conflict analysis employs multi-theoretical approaches to analyze complex real-world situations.

- **Materialist Limitations:** Strong emotional responses and substantial sacrifices during conflicts demonstrate that interest-based conflicts contain critical psychological and cultural elements that materialist analyses fail to recognize.
- **Interdisciplinary Synergy:** The future of conflict theory depends on merging knowledge from *psychology and anthropology with economics and political science* to produce advanced insights about conflict origins, development, and peaceful resolution methods.

CHAPTER FOUR: ROOT CAUSES OF CONFLICT AND VIOLENCE IN AFRICA

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1. INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

Africa in the last two decades has been classified as the most conflict-affected region globally, susceptible to both intra-state and inter-state wars (Obioji et al., 2019).

- **People-Centred Recovery (Adamaagashi et al., 2023):** Lasting solutions require prioritized investments in education, science/technology/innovation, health, decent job creation, gender equality, and youth empowerment.
- **Key Root Causes Identified:** Indigene-settler phenomenon, economic inequality, poverty, economic marginalization, social disputes, nationalist movements, colonial history legacies, climate change, resource scarcity, weak governance/corruption, proliferation of arms, foreign power interference, and religious extremism.

2. ROOT CAUSES OF CONFLICT IN AFRICA (DETAILED BREAKDOWN)

A. Indigene-Settler Phenomenon in Africa

Refers to persistent tensions between groups considered "original inhabitants" (indigenes) and those who migrated later (settlers) (Ukoha, 2019).

- **Definitions:**
  - *Indigenes:* "Sons of the soil" with ancestral ties to land/locality; cultural identity forms the foundation of local recognition.
  - *Settlers:* Groups who moved into a region for economic, political, or security reasons (often decades or centuries ago) but lack full indigenous status.
- **Colonial & Post-Colonial Origins:** Colonial administrators categorized populations by origin for tax collection, labor control, and indirect rule. Post-independence African governments retained these classifications.
  - *Nigerian Government Enforcement:* Implemented via local government indigene certificates, restrictions on political participation by ward/district of origin, and preferential access to public employment, scholarships, catchment areas, and quota systems under Sec. 42 of the 1999 Constitution (amended 2023).
- **Triggers of Indigene-Settler Conflict:** Institutionalized discrimination (Osaghae et al., 2022), land and resource competition, political instrumentalization by elites, and social fragmentation.

Case Study / Region	Timeline	Key Dynamics & Impact
Nigeria — Jos, Plateau State	2001 – 2010	Tensions between indigenous Berom, Afizere, Anaguta and settler Hausa-Fulani Muslims over local appointments and land led to thousands of deaths and community displacement (African Union Commission, 2023).
Côte d'Ivoire — Ivoirité Crisis	1990s – 2002	Concept of "Ivoirité" excluded northern Muslim citizens and descendants of immigrants from Mali/Burkina Faso. Disqualification of Alassane Ouattara sparked the 2002 civil war, displacing over 700,000 people (Adebayo, 2021).
Cameroon — Far North Region	2021	Clashes between indigenous farming communities and migrant Fulani herders over land/water. Over 40,000 people were displaced in 2021 alone (AfDB, 2022).

- **Policy Recommendations:** Abolish discriminatory classifications, promote residency-based citizenship laws, facilitate community dialogue, and educate against ethnic exclusion.

B. Economic Inequality, Poverty, and Economic Marginalization

Economic deprivation, structural injustice, and exclusion act as silent but powerful drivers of violence across Africa (World Bank, 2022).

- **Core Concepts (World Bank, 2022):**
  - *Economic Inequality:* Unequal distribution of wealth/income where a small elite prospers while the majority struggles with low wages and poor infrastructure.
  - *Poverty:* Multi-dimensional deprivation affecting income, food, housing, healthcare, education, and human dignity.
  - *Economic Marginalization:* Deliberate structural exclusion of ethnic/regional groups from economic participation, land, credit, or decision-making.
- **Why Economic Factors Drive Conflict:** Desperation and loss of hope, youth unemployment driving recruitment into violent gangs or rebel movements, perceived structural injustice, and resource-based competition.

Case Study / Region	Timeline	Key Dynamics & Impact
Nigeria — Niger Delta Militancy	Early 2000s	Movement for the Emancipation of the Niger Delta (MEND) emerged to protest oil pollution, poverty, and economic exclusion through pipeline attacks and kidnappings (Adebayo, 2021).
South Africa — Xenophobic Attacks	2008 – 2019	Apartheid economic legacy left high inequality. Frustration over scarce jobs and housing led to violent attacks killing dozens of African immigrants (Crush & Ramachandran, 2014).
Mali & Sahel Region	2021	Neglect of northern Tuareg and Fulani communities created economic frustration, driving recruitment into violent jihadist organizations (OECD, 2021).

Case Study / Region	Timeline	Key Dynamics & Impact
Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) — Resource Conflict & Poverty	Ongoing	DRC is rich in gold, cobalt, and diamonds, yet extremely poor in human development. Armed groups fight for control over mining in North/ South Kivu to fund operations, forcing local populations into extreme poverty without basic infrastructure.

Implications for Peace & Development: Escalation of armed conflict, weakening of national unity and social trust, politicization of ethnic identities, slowed economic growth, and refugee/forced migration crises.

Recommendations for Economic Inequality & Marginalization

- **Inclusive Economic Policies:** Budget allocation for rural infrastructure (roads, electricity, health), fair access to land/credit/markets for women/youth/rural dwellers, and targeted poverty alleviation programs in historically marginalized areas (Northern Mali, Northern Nigeria, Eastern DRC).
- **Youth Employment & Skills Development:** Vocational training, digital literacy, and public works programs to engage the young population (over 60% of Africa's population).
- **Decentralization & Local Empowerment:** Autonomy and funding for local governments.
- **Fair Resource Distribution:** Ensuring oil, mining, and tax revenues directly benefit host communities with civil society monitoring.
- **Social Safety Nets:** Cash transfers, school feeding programs, and universal healthcare (models proven in Ethiopia and Rwanda).
- **Good Governance:** Strengthening institutions to eliminate corruption and enforce the rule of law.

C. Social Grievances and Social Disputes

Disagreements over identity, access to services, cultural differences, or social justice (African Union, 2024). Deep social grievances are often historical, emotional, and deeply rooted in daily life.

- **Forms of Social Disputes:**
  - *Ethnic & Tribal Differences:* Africa has over 3,000 ethnic groups. Identity manipulation by political elites causes severe tension when one group dominates resources.
  - *Religious Differences:* Competition for influence, exploited by extremists and politicians.
  - *Gender-Based Injustice:* Early marriage, denial of education, and domestic violence leading to social resistance and protests.
  - *Youth Discontent & Generational Tensions:* Widening gap between older leadership and youth feeling disrespected by elders/governments, leading to street protests.

Case Study / Region	Timeline	Key Dynamics & Impact
Kenya — Electoral & Ethnic Violence	2007	Disputed presidential elections sparked severe ethnic violence between Kikuyu and Luo communities, leaving over 1,000 dead and hundreds of thousands displaced.
Nigeria — Farmer-Herder Clashes	Ongoing	Clashes in the Middle Belt between nomadic Fulani herders and sedentary farmers over land, water, and identity, exacerbated by climate change (International Crisis Group, 2021).
South Sudan — Intercommunal Violence	2011 – Present	Rival clans clashing over cattle, land, and dowry disputes, spiraling into armed conflict due to weak state structures (Krause, 2018).
Cameroon — Anglophone-Francophone Crisis	2020 – Present	Linguistic/cultural marginalization of English-speaking regions escalated into military confrontations, killing over 6,000 people and displacing 700,000+ (Amnesty International, 2020).

D. Separatist Agitations, Irredentism, and Nationalist Movements

Political and social efforts by specific groups seeking autonomy, self-governance, or total independence due to perceived political exclusion or historic oppression.

- **Historical Context:**
  - Pre-colonial Africa contained sovereign entities like the Mali Empire, Ashanti Kingdom, and Kingdom of Kongo.
  - **Berlin Conference (1884 – 1885):** Arbitrary borders drawn by European powers (Britain, France, Portugal, Belgium, Germany) without regard for ethnic or cultural realities.
  - Post-independence inherited centralized "winner-take-all" states, turning anti-colonial nationalism into sub-nationalist or ethnic separatist movements.

- **Irredentism Defined (Drury, 2022):** Movement advocating for the restoration of a territory to another country based on historical, ethnic, or cultural ties.
  - *Global/Regional Examples:* Russia's annexation of Crimea (2014), Somalia's invasion of Ethiopia's Ogaden Region (1977 – 1978), and Libya's invasion of the Aouzou Strip in Chad (resolved in favor of Chad by the ICJ in 1994).

Movement / Region	Timeline	Key Dynamics & Impact
Nigeria — Biafra Secessionist Movement	1967 – 1970 & Present	Biafra War (1967 – 1970) attempted Igbo secession (Eze, 2022). Resurged with IPOB citing economic exclusion and human rights abuses.
Cameroon — Ambazonia Movement	Ongoing	Anglophone regions seeking independent "Ambazonia", resulting in over 6,000 deaths and 700,000+ displaced (ICG, 2023).
Senegal — Casamance Separatists	1980s – Present	Southern Casamance region fighting for independence due to distinct ethnic/religious identity; peace efforts ongoing.
Mali & Niger — Tuareg Movements	2012 – Present	Tuareg rebeled against government neglect, declaring the state of "Azawad" in 2012 , which was later overtaken by jihadists.
DR Congo — Katanga Secession	1960 – Present	Mineral-rich Katanga province attempted secession shortly after independence in 1960 ; autonomy demands persist.

> **Recommendations for Separatist & Nationalist Agitations**
>
> Inclusive federalism and devolution of power, peaceful dialogue/mediation, equitable resource sharing, legal protection of minority identities, historical reconciliation, and youth employment initiatives.

E. Climate Change, Weak Governance, and Other Drivers

- **Climate Change & Resource Competition (UNEP, 2023):** Heatwaves, severe droughts, and shrinking water/farmland force migration and fuel violent clashes (e.g., Fulani herders moving south in Nigeria; worsening drought in Sudan's Darfur region).
- **Weak Governance & Corruption:** Lack of public trust and corrupt leadership leading to unemployment and violent crackdowns (e.g., Zimbabwe) or warlord control over vast territories (e.g., DR Congo).

F. Proliferation of Small Arms and Light Weapons (SALW)

Africa has been flooded with illegal, cheap, easy-to-carry, and hard-to-track weapons (especially AK-47s) following civil wars and foreign interventions.

- **Post-Gaddafi Libya:** Following Gaddafi's overthrow, weapons were smuggled across borders into West Africa, fueling violent conflicts in Mali, Burkina Faso, and Northern Nigeria.
- **South Sudan:** Proliferation of automatic weapons among ethnic groups transformed traditional cattle-raiding into full-blown armed battles.

G. External Interference from Foreign Powers

Foreign governments and multinational corporations intervening to secure cheap natural resources, influence political outcomes, or support compliant leaders/rebels.

- **DR Congo (DRC):** Foreign mining companies accused of funding armed warlords to secure illegal access to gold, coltan, and other minerals (Global Witness, 2025).
- **Cold War Interventions:** Superpowers (United States and Soviet Union) used African nations as ideological battlefields, proxy-funding wars in Angola and Ethiopia.

H. Rise of Terrorism and Religious Extremism

Violent groups exploiting religious dogmas to justify violence, particularly targeting poor, uneducated, and neglected populations (UNDP, 2023).

- **Boko Haram (Nigeria):** Originated in Northeastern Nigeria as a religious movement, evolving into a violent terrorist group conducting schoolgirl kidnappings, market bombings, and village raids.
- **Al-Shabaab (Somalia):** Recruits impoverished youth to launch terror attacks in Somalia, Kenya, and Uganda under the guise of religion.

3. EFFECTS OF CONFLICT IN AFRICA

- Displacement of millions of civilians into refugee camps or urban slums.
- Disruption of education for children, trapping future generations in poverty cycles.
- Destruction of economies due to investor flight from conflict zones.
- Loss of national sovereignty through permanent aid dependency.

4. COMPREHENSIVE RECOMMENDATIONS ACROSS LEVELS

Governance Level	Key Recommended Interventions
National Level	Equal treatment of all citizens regardless of ethnicity/religion; provision of employment, education, and justice; transforming security forces from abusers to protectors of citizens.
Regional Level	Joint conflict resolution through regional blocs like **ECOWAS, AU, and SADC** (African Union Commission, 2023); border security and stopping cross-border arms smuggling.
International Level	Halting foreign support for warlords and resource exploitation; backing peace education and youth initiatives; implementing **DDR programs (Disarmament, Demobilization, and Reintegration)** for ex-fighters.

> **Chapter 4 Conclusion**
>
> Conflict in Africa is driven by a complex combination of colonial historical legacies, weak state governance, ethnic identity politics, economic marginalization, and external influences. Sustainable peace requires moving past simplistic explanations and implementing locally led, context-specific solutions that prioritize justice, inclusion, and institutional accountability.

CHAPTER FIVE: SELECTED CONFLICT CASE STUDIES

By Marcia Chidinma Udem (Department of History and International Studies, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

Nigeria, a country of over 200 million people, was created by British colonialism, amalgamating diverse regional, ethnic, and linguistic groups (Imobighe, 2003). Conflicts between communities have been exacerbated by colonial borders, state creation, resource rivalry, and expanding land demands (Alubo, 2007).

- **Notable Regional Conflicts:** Ife-Modakeke (1999 – 2000), Aguleri-Umuleri (1995 – 2000), Yelwa-Shendam (2003 – 2005), Abagana-Ukpo (2017 – 2019), and Zango-Kataf (1999 – 2005) (Omotayo, 2005).
- **Definition of Conflict:** Pursuit of incompatible interests and goals by distinct groups (Otite & Albert, 2001 ; Bello & Olutola, 2016).

2. CASE STUDY 1: THE TIV-JUKUN CONFLICT

An ongoing conflict between the Tiv and Jukun ethnic groups in central Nigeria, predominantly in **Taraba State** (also affecting Benue, Nasarawa, Plateau, Adamawa, Bauchi, and Gombe states).

- **Historical Background:** Jukuns are considered early settlers in Wukari; Tivs arrived later as agricultural migrants. In 1922 , British colonial rulers gave Wukari administration to Jukuns, seeding long-term land ownership disputes.
- **Political Escalations & Timelines:**
  - **1956 Elections:** Charles Tangur Gaza (Tiv, UMBC) defeated Mallam Ibrahim Sangari (Jukun, NPC) for the Wukari federal seat. Tivs supported UMBC; Jukuns supported NPC.
  - **Major Violent Peaks:** Outbreaks in 1959 , 1964 , 1976 , 1981 – 1982 (post-1979 2nd Republic shift), 1990 – 1992 , peak in 2000 – 2001 (Ciboh, 2014), 2014 , and resurgence since 2019 .
- **Causes of Conflict:** Land encroachment & failed colonial "ring fence policy" (Egwu, 2004), language extinction fears & dominance of Hausa (Nnorom & Odigbo, 2015), indigene-settler political marginalization, and electoral power struggles.
- **Consequences:** ~5,000 deaths and tens of thousands relocated (Zuljan, 2019); crippling of Taraba State's economy (where farmers are 83% of the population); and disruption of primary through tertiary education (Tyessi, 2012).
- **Peace Efforts:** Catholic Church mediation & IDP repatriation (Fides, 2023); Nasarawa Governor Abdullahi Sule's mediation (April 2020) (Abogonye, 2020); and Benue-Taraba Cross-Border 9-point peace pact (April 2020).

3. CASE STUDY 2: THE ZANGO-KATAF CONFLICT

Longstanding dispute between the indigenous **Atyap (Kataf)** people and **Hausa-Fulani settlers** in Zangon Kataf LGA, Kaduna State (headquarters in Zonkwa).

- **Historical Origins:** Traced to 1922 when Emir of Zaria Dalhatu Uthman Yero acquired Atyap land without compensation. In 1966 , Emir Muhammad Usman donated land for "Zangon Kataf" Hausa marketplace (Falola, 2001 ; Aliyu, 2016), where Atyap were barred from trading pork/alcohol.

- **1992 Outbreak Timeline:**
  - **January 1992:** First indigenous LGA Chairman A.C.P. Juri Babang Ayok (rtd) announced market relocation to a neutral site to end Hausa monopoly.
  - **February 1992:** Violent clashes over market transfer left 60+ dead.
  - **May 15–16, 1992:** Major riot erupted in Zango, killing 400+ people and destroying buildings (Canada Immigration Board, 1992 ; HRW, 2013), triggering Christian-Muslim reprisal killings across Kaduna.
- **Causes:** Land supremacy disputes, armed Fulani grazing on farmlands (Luka, 2017), discriminatory market trading rights, and ethno-religious polarization.

Ethnic and Religious Differences (Zango-Kataf): Overlaid with religious overtones: Hausa/Fulani are predominantly Muslim settlers, while Atyap are predominantly Christian indigenes claiming historic ownership (Salauwa, 2010).

- **Consequences & Aftermath of Zango-Kataf Crisis:**
  - *Displacement & Property Loss: Massive destruction, widowed women, and orphaned children (Apuwabi, 2018). Official records state the May 1992 violence claimed ~471 lives (250 in Kaduna, Ikara, and surrounding districts), injured 518+ people, destroyed 229 homes, and burned 218 vehicles (Rotimi, 1996).*
  - *Retaliatory Attacks: Hausa and Fulani youth launched violent reprisal attacks against Christians of all ethnic groups across Kaduna, Zaria, and Ikara (Rotimi, 1996).*
  - *Arrests & Sentences: Military government arrested hundreds of Atyap leaders, including retired LGA Chairman A.C.P. Juri B. Ayok, District Head Bala Ade Dauke Gora, and retired Major General Zamani Lekwot (African Watch, 1993). Sentences were eventually mitigated after intervention by the **African Commission on Human and People's Rights**.*

- ***Efforts Towards Peace (Zango-Kataf):***
  - *Commissions of Inquiry: Justice Rahila Cudjoe Commission of Inquiry (1992) and Air Vice-Marshal Usman Mu'azu Reconciliation Group (1995). In June–July 2020 , Kaduna State set up an 8-member white paper committee on both enquiries (Amos, 2022).*
  - *Reconciliation & Interfaith Initiatives: Global Peace Foundation Nigeria outreach (2022); Atyap Chiefdom Peace and Security Partnership Committee (ACPSPC); dialogue with Fulani leaders; and stakeholder meetings to abolish curfews and rebuild infrastructure (The Conclave, 2020).*

4. CASE STUDY 3: THE AGULERI-UMULERI CONFLICT

*A longstanding feud between two sister Igbo clans (Aguleri and Umuleri) in Anambra State over the ownership and governance of **Otuocha**, a river beach land along the Omambala (Anambra) River (Obiakor, 2016).*

- ***Historical Conflict Timeline:***
  - ***1933:** First recorded violent clash over Otuocha land, resulting in no fatalities.*
  - ***December 1964:** Clashes reoccurred with very few deaths and minor property damage.*
  - ***1993:** Litigation claims and counterclaims in several courts culminated in violent outbreaks.*
  - ***1995 War:** War took on new dimensions with heavy casualties, destruction of property, and excessive acquisition of weaponry (rifles/ammunition).*
  - ***April 2, 1999 War:** Full-scale internal warfare broke out, inflicting severe casualties and mass destruction across all sides, drawing state and federal government intervention.*

- ***Causes of Conflict:***
  - *Land Ownership & Border Demarcation: Intensive rival claims to Otuocha territory (Ifediora, 1995).*
  - *Historical Grievances & Cultural Differences: Long-standing hostility over title and differing community traditions.*
  - *Excessive Community Militarization: Both sides acquired automatic arms after the 1995 Obele clash.*
  - *Early Governance Failure: Failure of the Anambra State Government to address and resolve the conflict at an early stage.*

- ***Consequences of the Aguleri-Umuleri War:***
  - *Severe loss of life, general insecurity, armed robbery, and prolonged family dislocation.*
  - *Desertion of towns and families fleeing as refugees throughout Nigeria; men, women, and older siblings abandoning dependents.*
  - *Disruption of agriculture (90% of local population are farmers) due to farmland loss and vigilante activities along the Anambra River.*
  - *Long-term socio-economic backwardness and stalled infrastructure development.*

- ***Efforts Towards Peace (Aguleri-Umuleri):***
  - *Traditional & Religious Mediation: Community elders and Christian leaders (especially the Catholic Church) conducted prayer sessions, peace meetings, and reconciliation.*
  - *Government Interventions: Deployment of military/police security forces (1995 – 1999) and judicial border demarcation attempts.*
  - *Community & Youth Initiatives: Joint cooperative development projects (schools, health centers) engaging youth in constructive activities.*
  - *Current Status: Relative stability and significantly lower violence maintained since the early 2000s .*

> ***Chapter 5 Conclusion***
>
> *Selected Nigerian conflict cases demonstrate the deep complexity of ethno-religious, communal, and resource-based disputes. Resolving these challenges requires re-examining problematic colonial boundaries under state supervision, promoting inclusive dialogue, driving economic development, and ensuring good governance.*

CHAPTER SIX: APPROACHES TO PEACE-BUILDING AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

By Chukwukere Justice Ihetu (Department of Religion and Human Relations, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

Approaches to peacebuilding and conflict resolution vary according to the nature of the conflict, the history of the conflict, and the culture within which it takes place (Onu, 2009). Morris (2008) identifies several major approaches to peacebuilding and conflict resolution.

2. NINE APPROACHES TO PEACE-BUILDING AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

1. Negotiation

A process in which two or more participants attempt to reach a joint decision on matters of common concern in situations of actual or potential disagreement (Morris, 2008). Miller (2003) defines it as communication governed by pre-established procedures between representatives of parties in a dispute.

- ***Power Negotiation:*** *Involves a negotiator's understanding and strategic use of various sources of power to achieve bargaining goals (Morris, 2008).*
- ***Interest-Based Negotiation:*** *Focuses on reaching resolutions that meet the interests of all parties involved rather than bargaining over positions. Also known as "problem-solving negotiation", "all gain negotiation", or "value creating negotiation".*
- ***Direct Process (Onu, 2009):*** *A direct process of dialogue and discussion taking place between at least two conflicting parties.*
- ***Dual Challenge (Piombo, 2010):*** *Negotiators face the challenge of deciding whether to address root causes or simply facilitate a ceasefire for humanitarian relief.*
  - *Burundi Crisis (1993 – 2005): Required multiple rounds of talks between Hutu and Tutsi ethnic groups.*
  - *Bosnia and Serbia War (Spring 1992 – Late 1995): Negotiation ended a major phase of the war.*

2. Collaboration / Collaborative Negotiation

Sees negotiation not as a confrontation between adversaries seeking maximum gain, but as a collaboration where each side seeks to do well while acting as a potential collaborator (Onuoha, 2009). Parties educate each other about needs/concerns to solve problems mutually (Best, 2005).

3. Mediation

A process where an impartial third party helps disputants resolve a dispute or plan a transaction without the power to impose a binding solution (LeBaron Duryea, 2001). Miller (2003) notes it as a voluntary, informal, and non-binding process.

- ***Forms of Mediators (Morris, 2008):***
  - *Evaluative Mediators: Offer suggestions and recommendations to conflicting parties (common in labor and commercial disputes).*

- *Transformative Mediators: Focus on transforming relationships rather than merely reaching settlements.*

- ***Cultural Awareness (Williams, 2003):*** *Mediators must understand how their individual cultural context shapes procedural acceptability and bridge high/low context cultures.*
- ***Darfur Conflict Case Study (2003 – 2004) (Ochoga & Lawal, 2013):***
  - *African Union (AU) stepped in as mediator between Janjaweed/Sudanese Government and rebel groups.*
  - *At its 4th Ordinary Session in Abuja (Jan 30–31, 2004), AU appointed **Dr. Salim Ahmed Salim** as Chief Mediator/Special Envoy. Talks involved Government of Sudan, Justice and Equality Movement (JEM), and Sudan Liberation Movement Army (SLMA), yielding two short-term peace agreements.*

4. Conciliation

*Distinguished from mediation by procedure: in conciliation, parties in dispute are usually **not in the same room** with the conciliator (Onu, 2009 ; Morris, 2008). Uses **"shuttle diplomacy"** by communicating with each side separately. Best (2005) defines it as intermediary efforts aimed at persuading parties toward peaceful resolution prior to negotiation.*

5. Adjudication (Arbitration)

*Decision-making by a judge in court, administrative tribunal, or an arbitrator where an adjudicator determines a **final, binding, and enforceable decision** (Morris, 2008). Can be ordered by court or compelled by statute.*

- ***African Context (Best, 2005):*** *Traditional African societies frequently resolve land disputes via arbitration.*

6. Non-Binding Arbitration

Disputing parties present their case to an impartial third party who renders an opinion or recommendation that parties can choose to accept or reject (Morris, 2008). If rejected, parties usually proceed to court trial.

7. Dialogue

> ***Etymology of Dialogue:*** *Derived from Greek dialogos — dia ("through", "between") and logos ("speech", "words", "meaning of words"). Literally translates to **"through words"** or **"flow of meaning"** (dia lagos).*

- ***Core Objective (Yankelovich, 1999 ; Laske, 2010):*** *Grassroots peacebuilding tool to reciprocally clarify awareness and build mutual understanding. Open to possible results without prescribing rigid ends.*
- ***Case Study (Salami & Kpac, 2022):*** *The Aguleri-Umuleri-Umuoba Anam communal war (2000) was resolved through a series of structured dialogues led by traditional rulers.*

8. Peacekeeping

A newer form of third-party peaceful intervention designed to prevent conflict escalation, contain hostilities, and maintain peace via international forces (soldiers, police, civilians) (Keener & Keener, 2006).

- ***UN Charter Basis (Onumajuru, 2005):*** *Described as a "child of necessity" adapting provisions from **Chapter VI and VII of the UN Charter** to create an enabling environment for peace.*
- ***Core Requirements:*** *Consent of disputing parties, pre-determined ceasefire agreement, non-use of force except in self-defense, and strict political sensitivity/neutrality.*

9. Peace Enforcement

*Involves the **use of armed force** to maintain or restore international peace and security when the UN Security Council determines the existence of a threat, breach of peace, or act of aggression (Onumajuru, 2005).*

- ***Legal Foundation:** Provided under **Chapter VII of the United Nations Charter** when all peaceful efforts fail.*
- ***Distinction from Peacekeeping:** Does not require party consent and employs active military force.*
- ***Historical Interventions (Henry, 2015):** UN peace enforcement operations in Somalia (1990s), Bosnia (1990s), Korean War, and Gulf War (1991).*

> #### Chapter 6 Summary & Conclusion
>
> *Peacebuilding and conflict resolution require adaptive, multi-faceted approaches tailored to historical, cultural, and political dynamics. From voluntary negotiations and shuttle diplomacy conciliation to binding legal adjudication and UN Chapter VII peace enforcement, choosing the appropriate mechanism is critical for lasting peace.*

CHAPTER SEVEN: ELEMENTS OF PEACE STUDIES AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

By Ugochukwu Titus Ugwu (Department of Sociology/Anthropology, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. INTRODUCTION & ANTHROPOLOGY OF PEACE

The anthropology of peace and conflict resolution is an expansive interdisciplinary domain synthesizing theoretical frameworks, methodologies, and empirical case studies to illuminate human conflict dynamics. It integrates perspectives from cultural anthropology, sociology, political science, and peace studies, emphasizing the ***emic (insider) view*** *of local perspectives and lived experiences.*

2. CORE CONCEPTS

A. Cultural Relativism vs. Moral Relativism

- ***Cultural Relativism:*** *Foundational principle asserting that cultures must be understood and evaluated on their own terms, rather than through external, ethnocentric lenses (Berry et al., 2002 ; Barnard, 2004 ; Pickering, 2008). Vital for designing culturally sensitive peacebuilding initiatives.*
- ***Moral Relativism Tension:*** *Uncritical application of cultural relativism can lead to moral relativism, where harmful cultural practices are justified even when they infringe upon universal human rights. Anthropologists must respect local customs while upholding fundamental human dignity.*

B. Conflict Transformation

A holistic process aimed at altering the fundamental structures and relationships that generate conflict, rather than merely addressing overt symptoms (Francis, 2002 ; Babatunde, 2020). Seeks to build equitable social systems capable of managing differences constructively.

C. Conflict Dynamics and Assessment Scales

Conflict dynamics refer to the evolving patterns of interaction, perceptions, and behaviors among disputing parties. Assessment scales serve to diagnose underlying causes and potential trajectories (Nunkoo & Sungkur, 2021).

Assessment Framework	Core Features & Key Components
Conflict Dynamics Profile (CDP)	*Measures observable **conflict behaviors** rather than fixed personality styles. Identifies specific emotional triggers (**"hot buttons"**).* *• CDP-Individual (CDP-I): Self-report tool providing quick, cost-effective feedback on individual reactions.* *• CDP-360: Multi-rater tool comparing self-perceptions with feedback from bosses, peers, and direct reports (vital for leaders and high-potential managers).*
USAID Conflict Assessment Framework (CAF/ICAF/VCA)	*Suite of diagnostic tools used by USAID to analyze national and sub-national conflict, violence, and peace dynamics.* *4-Step Process: 1. **Evaluate Context:** Broad environment (elitism, exclusion, corruption, institutional deficits).* *2. **Understand Core Grievances:** Sources of discontent and social resilience.* *3. **Identify Drivers & Mitigating Factors:** Motivations and resources driving violence vs. local peace traditions and values.* *4. **Describe Opportunities:** Identifying "windows of vulnerability" (escalation risks) and "windows of opportunity" (de-escalation openings).*
Global Partnership for the Prevention of Armed Conflict (GPPAC) Framework	*Adaptable guide primarily used by Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) to strengthen conflict analysis capacity, self-assessment, and program planning (Nunkoo & Sungkur, 2021). Structured into two parts: Getting Started/ Gathering Information and Analysing Information Gathered.*
Early Warning Systems (EWS)	*Processes designed to identify potential crises before escalation, providing timely warnings to decision-makers and enabling proactive conflict prevention and efficient resource allocation.*

3. DESTRUCTIVE VS. CONSTRUCTIVE CONFLICTS

Destructive Conflict

Characterized by perceived goal/value incompatibilities, adversarial attempts to control opponents, and pervasive antagonistic feelings (Nunkoo & Sungkur, 2021).

- ***Manifestations:** Verbal/physical aggression, hostility, **stonewalling** (refusal to communicate), blaming, and direct personal attacks.*
- ***Conflict Entrepreneurs:** Individuals who actively work to maintain drama, oversimplify complex issues into "us vs. them" mentalities, and keep emotions high (Vallacher et al., 2013).*
- ***Psychological & Group Drivers:***
  - *Ethnocentrism: Glorifying one's own group while denigrating others.*
  - *Mirror Imaging: A phenomenon where each conflicting group views the other negatively while viewing itself positively.*
  - *Groupthink: Prioritizing group consensus over realistic appraisals.*
- ***Societal Impact:** Deep-seated resentment, severely strained relationships, broken trust, and adverse psychological outcomes in children (inter-parental conflict).*

Constructive Conflict

Characterized by an embrace of diverse perspectives to improve situations through healthy, intellectual debate (Francis, 2008 ; Anthony, 2017). Focuses on shared goals rather than personal grievances.

- ***Guiding Principles:*** *Mutual respect, open communication, honesty, active listening, and promoting self-awareness without seeking a single "winner".*
- ***Objectives:*** *Enhancing team collaboration, encouraging creative innovation, building leadership skills, and reducing social tension.*

Strategies for Managing Conflict (Individual vs. Organizational Level)

- ***Individual Level:***
  - *Refuse Gottman's destructive tactics: criticism, contempt, defensiveness, stonewalling (Anthony, 2017).*
  - *Speak non-defensively, validate emotions, focus on one issue at a time to prevent a "mudslinging contest", adopt a "win-win" mindset, use soft voices/humor, and seek timely closure.*
- ***Organizational/Group Level:***
  - *Establish **psychological safety** so team members express concerns without fear of judgment.*
  - *Use structured conversation frameworks (active listening, turn-taking), redirect discussions to solutions, encourage diverse views, and provide skills coaching.*

4. CULTURAL APPROACHES & ETHNOGRAPHIC METHODS

A. Ethnographic & Participatory Research

- ***Ethnography in Peace Studies:*** *Involves long-term fieldwork and **participant observation** to gain an immersive, emic understanding of conflict-affected communities that quantitative methods miss (Harris, 1968).*
- ***Participatory Approaches:*** *Actively involve local communities as co-owners in research, fostering empowerment and producing contextually relevant peacebuilding strategies (Pickering, 2008).*

B. Indigenous Dispute Resolution Mechanisms (African Examples)

Traditional societies prioritize reconciliation, social harmony, and restorative justice over retributive punishment.

Region / Culture	Traditional Mechanism & Key Features
Ethiopia (Mengehacha System)	*Ritual reconciliation conducted beside a river/valley involving symbolic acts (breaking a goat's leg, stretching its intestines, mutual hugging, shared meals). Serves as a hybrid supplement to formal courts.*
Ethiopia (Michu Institution)	*Traditional "friendship" system among Gumuz and highlanders (Oromo, Shinasha, Agaw, Amhara) to build cultural tolerance (Mohamed, 2018).*
Ethiopia (Mao & Komo Societies)	*Elder-led dispute resolution ranging from compensation for minor offenses to retaliatory measures for intentional homicide (Hargreaves, 1986).*
Zimbabwe (BaTonga Tribe)	*Resolution via family elders, traditional leaders, and spirit mediums using discussions, folktales, counseling, and herbs (Molema, 1920).*
Botswana (Setswana Culture)	*Combines customary and judicial law via chiefs/headmen. Built on consultation (therisanyo) and open discussion: "ntwakgolo key a molomo" (meaning **great battles are fought verbally**) (Lee & Lee, 2013 ; Denbow, 2006).*
Nigeria (Yoruba)	*Clan disputes elevated to ward chiefs, palace chiefs, the Oba (Oni), and ultimately the **Ogboni house** for arbitration (Bascom, 1969).*
Nigeria (Igbo — Ohafia)	*Age-sets execute sanctions; Akpan arrests offenders; Umuaka arbitrate; **Ndi Ichin** (retired elders) advise; Ama ala acts as village assembly (Nsugbe, 1974). **Ekpe society** and igbandu enforce peace (McCall, 2000).*

5. KINSHIP SYSTEMS AND AGE-SETS IN MEDIATION

- ***Kinship Systems:*** *Social backbone regulating marriage, inheritance, and identity. In societies like the Nuer of South Sudan, political allegiance and dispute management are intricately rooted in kinship ties (Barnard & Spencer, 2009 ; Fortes & Evans-Pritchard, 2015).*
- ***Age-Sets:*** *Social structures grouping individuals by age as they progress through life stages. Define communal responsibilities, defense, and judicial roles (e.g., Masai age-sets defining male roles from warriors to advisory elders) (Tobergte & Curtis, 2013).*

6. CRITIQUES AND ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

- ***Broad Scope:*** *Field can be overly broad, potentially diluting analytical rigor.*
- ***Cultural Relativism vs. Universal Human Rights:*** *Uncritical relativism risks condoning harmful practices that violate human dignity (Nanda & Warms, 2007).*
- ***Overlooking Macro-Structures:*** *Hyper-focus on local context may miss global economic forces, historical injustices, or colonial legacies (Nanda & Warms, 2007).*

Chapter 7 Conclusion

The anthropology of peace offers a critical, culturally nuanced lens for understanding conflict and sustainable peace. By leveraging ethnographic methods and indigenous mechanisms (kinship, age-sets, ritual reconciliation), it provides compelling alternatives to Western-centric peacebuilding models while challenging the notion that conflict is inherently destructive.

CHAPTER EIGHT: JUSTICE AND LEGAL FRAMEWORK FOR PEACE AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

By Chinyelu Ifeoma Emechebe (Faculty of Law, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. CONCEPT AND CORE ELEMENTS OF SOCIAL JUSTICE

Concept of Social Justice

Social justice is the principle that promotes fairness and equity in the distribution of resources, opportunities, rights, and privileges within a society. It emphasizes equal rights regardless of social status, background, or position, seeking to eliminate systemic inequalities and uphold fundamental human rights. Foundational ideas were shaped by philosophers like ***Plato, Aristotle, and John Rawls****.*

Seven Core Elements of Social Justice

Element	Core Definition & Function
1. Equity	*Recognizes that individual needs and circumstances differ; ensures resources and opportunities are distributed specifically to address these differences.*
2. Access	*Ensures every community member has adequate access to basic amenities (education, healthcare, employment, housing) without discrimination.*
3. Participation	*Insinuates that all individuals should engage in activities and decision-making processes that influence their lives.*
4. Rights	*Entails that every member's fundamental rights are protected without discrimination or prejudice.*
5. Recognition	*Insinuates that the identities, cultural heritage, and contributions of every member are preserved without systemic prejudice.*
6. Fairness & Redistribution	*Ensures resources, wealth, and opportunities are allocated equally in society without bias.*
7. Accountability	*Ensures every individual, organization, institution, or government is held responsible for promoting transparency.*

Social Justice in the Nigerian Context

- *In multi-ethnic and multi-religious Nigeria, social justice fosters national unity and equitable resource distribution across all 36 states and the Federal Capital Territory (FCT).*
- ***Constitutional Provision:*** *Chapter II of the* 1999 *Nigerian Constitution (Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy) mandates that every state must ensure its citizens have access to quality healthcare, adequate housing, food, and education.*
- ***Challenges:*** *Corruption, political marginalization, regional inequality, and persistent communal conflicts hinder full realization.*

2. THE NIGERIAN LEGAL SYSTEM

Formed on the legacy of British colonialism (which introduced English common law and statutes in the 19th century alongside indigenous customary law). Following independence in 1960 *, Nigeria developed a plural legal system based on the* 1999 *Constitution (as amended).*

Six Sources of Nigerian Law

1. ***The Constitution:*** 1999 *Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (as amended) is the supreme law of the land. Any law inconsistent with its provisions is void to the extent of the inconsistency.*
2. ***Legislation (Statutes):*** *Laws passed by State Houses of Assembly for states and the National Assembly for the Federation governing administrative, commercial, civil, and criminal matters.*
3. ***English Common Law & Doctrines of Equity:*** *Acquired during colonial rule, still impacting areas where local laws do not apply.*
4. ***Judicial Precedents (Case Law):*** *Based on stare decisis, where lower courts are bound by the rulings of higher courts.*
5. ***Customary Law:*** *Unwritten indigenous laws regulating interpersonal and group relations, valid as long as they do not conflict with equity, natural justice, or morality.*
6. ***Islamic (Sharia) Law:*** *Regulates personal (and occasionally criminal) affairs for Muslims in certain northern Nigerian states under legal pluralism.*

Structure of the Nigerian Court System (Hierarchy)

Court Tier	Jurisdiction & Role
1. Supreme Court of Nigeria	*Highest court with final appellate jurisdiction over all cases; rulings bind all lower courts.*
2. Court of Appeal	*Hears appeals from State High Courts, Federal High Court, Sharia Courts of Appeal, and Customary Courts of Appeal.*
3. Federal High Court	*Deals with express constitutional matters, federal agencies, revenue, taxation, copyright, and immigration.*
4. State High Courts	*Highest court in a state, possessing broad jurisdiction over civil and criminal matters.*
5. Sharia Court of Appeal	*Resolves appeals involving Islamic personal law in states that embrace Sharia.*
6. Customary Court of Appeal	*Resolves appeals pertaining to applicable state customary law.*
7. Magistrate & Customary Courts	*Subordinate trial courts handling less serious criminal and civil cases locally.*

Legal Profession and Administration of Justice

- ***Single Legal Profession:*** *All attorneys are called to the Bar as both* ***barristers and solicitors****.*
- ***Key Bodies:***
  - ***Nigerian Bar Association (NBA):*** *Professional body upholding the rule of law, setting conduct standards, and promoting Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR).*
  - ***Council of Legal Education (CLE):*** *Regulates law schools and maintains legal education standards.*

- ***Legal Aid Council of Nigeria (LACON):*** *Improves legal representation access for indigent citizens who cannot afford legal services.*
- ***National Judicial Council (NJC):*** *Constitutional body preserving judicial independence, appointing, and disciplining judges.*

Challenges of the Nigerian Legal System

- *Bribery, corruption, graft, and unethical conduct creating access gaps between rich and poor.*
- *Dilapidated courtrooms lacking digital recording equipment, air conditioning, and proper lighting.*
- *Slow pace of justice with frequent adjournments and severe case backlogs.*
- *Inconsistencies and confusion arising from the coexistence of common law, Sharia law, and customary law.*

3. RELEVANCE & LEGAL FRAMEWORK FOR PEACE AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

(1) Constitutional Provisions (1999 Constitution as Amended)

- ***Section 14(2)(b):*** *Declares that the security and welfare of the people shall be the primary purpose of government.*
- ***Section 6:*** *Vests judicial powers of the Federation in the courts to resolve disputes and administer justice.*
- ***Section 36:*** *Guarantees every citizen the right to a fair hearing within a reasonable time.*
- ***Section 230:*** *Empowers the National Industrial Court to establish an Alternative Dispute Resolution Centre to resolve labor disputes.*

(2) Relevant Laws and Statutes

- ***Criminal and Penal Codes:*** *Handle rioting, assault, arson, and unlawful assembly in Southern and Northern Nigeria respectively.*
- ***Public Order Act:*** *Authorizes security forces to curtail activities threatening public order.*
- ***The Election Act:*** *Enacted to settle disputes arising from electoral processes.*
- ***Terrorism (Prevention and Prohibition) Act (2022):*** *Framework for counter-terrorism and insurgency conflict management.*
- ***Land Use Act:*** *Governs land tenure and usage to minimize land ownership disputes.*
- ***Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Act:*** *Mitigates environmental disputes caused by ecological degradation in resource/oil-producing regions.*

(3) Formal / State-Based Institutions

- ***Supreme Court of Nigeria: Interprets the constitution and settles inter-state or federal-state disputes.***
- ***Nigeria Police Force (NPF): Maintains law and order, prevents crime, and protects citizens.***
- ***Department of State Services (DSS): Responsible for internal security and intelligence.***
- ***Ministry of Justice: Provides legal advice to the government and enforces laws.***
- ***National Human Rights Commission (NHRC): Promotes and protects human rights across Nigeria.***
- ***National Orientation Agency (NOA): Promotes national values, unity, and integration.***

- ***National Assembly:*** *Makes laws and provides executive oversight.*

(4) Regional and Community-Based Frameworks

- ***Customary and Sharia Courts: State judicial systems settling local civil/personal matters according to local customs or Islamic law.***
- ***Councils of Elders and Traditional Rulers: Resolve family conflicts, land claims, and communal crises outside formal courtrooms.***
- ***Religious Leaders & Interfaith Councils: Advance peace by facilitating interfaith dialogue and communication.***

(5) Peacebuilding Policies and Programs in Nigeria

- ***1. National Policy on Peacebuilding and Conflict Management: Designed to formulate grassroots peacebuilding tactics, early warning mechanisms, and conflict sensitivity in policy execution.***
- ***2. National Security Strategy (NSS): Focuses on developing comprehensive strategies to address both internal and external security threats to Nigeria's peace and stability.***
- ***3. National Early Warning and Response Mechanism: Designed to track conflict indicators and initiate response measures in collaboration with ECOWAS and civil society organizations.***

4. CHALLENGES IN THE LEGAL FRAMEWORK FOR CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- ***Inadequate basic facilities across many courts in Nigeria, impeding effective dispute resolution.***
- ***Judicial and law enforcement corruption, undermining public trust and principles of fairness.***
- ***Limited capacity, marked by insufficient training and resources for judges, lawyers, and law enforcement officers.***
- ***Regulatory clutter, with an overabundance of overlapping laws creating confusion and inconsistencies.***
- ***Outdated laws that fail to address contemporary, evolving conflict resolution needs.***
- ***Poor enforcement of court judgments and arbitration awards, eroding system credibility.***
- ***Lack of proper accountability for perpetrators of violence or human rights abuses.***

5. ALTERNATIVE DISPUTE RESOLUTION (ADR) IN NIGERIA

ADR describes a group of non-formal court procedures used to settle disputes faster, more economically, and outside formal court proceedings. In Nigeria, ADR is officially recognized and integrated into the legal framework.

Core ADR Mechanisms & Legal Statutory Framework

ADR Mechanism	Definition, Features & Statutory Enactment
Negotiation	***Parties are encouraged to dialogue directly (in person or via representatives) to reach a consensus reflecting mutual interests.***
Conciliation	***A third party guides disputing parties toward a mutually agreeable solution. Introduced and governed under Section 78 of the Arbitration and Mediation Act, 2023 (usually written, signed by parties, and enforceable as a contract).***
Mediation	***A neutral third party facilitates dialogue and communication without imposing binding solutions or proposing terms of settlement. Terms can be enforced as court judgments if registered under Sections 87–89 of the Arbitration and Mediation Act (AMA), 2023.***
Arbitration	***Most formal ADR mechanism where a panel/arbitrator hears submissions and renders a binding and enforceable decision.*** ***• Key Case Precedent: In Statoil Nig. Ltd v. NNPC (2013) 14 NWLR (pt 1373) 1, the Supreme Court emphasized the binding nature of arbitration awards as a viable alternative to litigation.*** ***• International Model Adaptation: Nigeria's arbitration practices adopt the United Nations Commission on International Trade Law (UNCITRAL) Model Law.*** ***• Statutory Base: The Arbitration and Mediation Act, 2023 provides a unified framework for commercial disputes.***

Innovations & Judicial Support for ADR

- ***Multi-Door Courthouse System: Implemented in regions like Lagos, Abuja, and Kano to combine ADR options ("doors" like arbitration, mediation, conciliation) with formal litigation.***
- ***Community & Traditional Hybrid Systems: In rural areas, traditional elders, chiefs, and religious leaders act as mediators, bridging formal and customary justice systems.***
- ***Supreme Court Affirmation of ADR: In Ecobank Nig. Ltd v. Anchorage Leisures Ltd (2018) 16 NWLR (pt 1643) 438, the Supreme Court reaffirmed its strong support for ADR and upheld agreements referring disputes to ADR institutions, reducing court case burdens.***

Chapter 8 Conclusion

Sustainable peace, national unity, and effective conflict resolution in Nigeria depend on strengthening social justice, reforming the formal legal system, addressing systemic court challenges, and actively promoting Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) as a faster, cost-effective, and accessible alternative to traditional litigation.

CHAPTER NINE: INSURGENCY AND TERRORISM

By Uzodinma Chukwuemeka Okafor (Department of Political Science, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. CONCEPTUALIZATION: INSURGENCY VS. TERRORISM

Insurgency and terrorism are distinct yet frequently intertwined concepts representing two different approaches and levels of political violence executed against the state (Okafor, 2026).

Concept	Definition, Core Features & Operational Aims
Insurgency	***A sustained, armed rebellion against a government by a non-state group/ movement, aiming to control or partially control a country through irregular forces (Stoker, 2019).*** ***• CIA Definition (1986): Organized use of subversion and violence to seize, nullify, or challenge political control of a region.*** ***• Key Features: Asymmetry (weaker non-state group vs. stronger state apparatus), political motivation, seeking popular support ("hearts and minds"), protracted conflict, and blending with civilians.*** ***• Nigerian Manifestations: Niger Delta militancy (early 2000s) and ongoing Boko Haram/ISWAP insurgencies in the Northeast (Ikedinma, 2017).***
Terrorism	***Calculated use or threat of violence to instill mass fear in a population to achieve political, religious, or ideological objectives (CIA, 2004 ; UN General Assembly, 1994).*** ***• Etymology & History: Coined during the French Revolution's "Reign of Terror" (1790s) under Maximilien Robespierre and the Jacobin Party (1793 – 1794).*** ***• "Terrorist Triangle" (Schmid, 2011): Actor A (terrorist) attacks Target B (victims) to influence Audience C (government/public).*** ***• Nature: Described as the "weapon of the weakest" (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 2025) when direct military victory is unattainable. Uses symbolic violence (e.g., 2014 Chibok schoolgirls abduction; attacks on markets, churches, mosques, UN buildings) to erode government legitimacy (Ogungbile, 2020 ; Ikedinma, 2017).***

2. HISTORICAL EVOLUTION OF TERRORISM AND INSURGENCY

- ***Ancient Roots: Ancient Greek historian Xenophon (431 – 350 BCE) commented on psychological warfare. Roman Emperors Tiberius (14 – 37 CE) and Caligula (37 – 41 CE) institutionalized state terror via banishment, property confiscation, and public executions.***
- ***Early Non-State Terrorism: The Sicarii (a Jewish extremist group/Zealots in 1st-century Judea) conducted targeted assassinations against Hebrews collaborating with Roman authorities (Horsley, 1979 ; Smith, 2018 ; Tacitus, 2008).***

- *Reign of Terror (1793 – 1794): French Revolution state terror executed via the guillotine to purge anti-revolutionaries. Simultaneously, the Spanish Inquisition used arbitrary arrests and torture against heresy.*
- *Post-Civil War US (1861 – 1865): Ku Klux Klan (KKK) emerged as a paramilitary group using lynchings, cross-burnings, and intimidation to suppress newly freed Black Americans' rights.*
- *Anarchist Wave (1865 – 1905): Anarchist movements in Western Europe, Russia, and the US assassinated heads of state (kings, presidents, prime ministers) using bombings/ shootings.*
- *20th Century Modalities & Totalitarianism: Technological advances (automatic weapons, time-detonated explosives, commercial aviation) expanded reach. Totalitarian regimes under Adolf Hitler (Nazi Germany) and Joseph Stalin (Soviet Union) institutionalized state terror (forced labor camps, purges) (Smith, 2018).*
- *State-Sponsored & Liberation Ambiguity: Nation-states used terrorism as a foreign policy tool under the guise of supporting "national liberation" (e.g., ANC during Apartheid; French Resistance in WWII; Barrett, 1990 ; Skabash, 2023).*

3. OPERATIONAL STRATEGIES OF INSURGENT/TERRORIST GROUPS

1. *Guerrilla Warfare: Hit-and-run tactics, ambushes, and sabotage exploiting terrain and mobility to wear down superior forces (Seymour, 2025).*
2. *Psychological Operations: Propaganda, mass abductions, and public executions to instill terror and attract global media attention (Ogungbile, 2020).*
3. *Political Subversion: Infiltrating institutions, forming parallel local governments/courts in controlled zones (CIA, 1986).*
4. *Sabotage & Infrastructure Attacks: Attacking oil pipelines, power grids, and transit networks to disrupt the economy (Ikedinma, 2017).*
5. *Intelligence & Counterintelligence: Relying on local informants while shielding networks from state infiltration (Military Strategy Magazine, 2019).*
6. *Use of Safe Havens: Operating from remote/inaccessible areas (forests, mountains, cross-border zones) where state presence is weak.*
7. *Mobilization of Identity: Exploiting ethnic/religious divisions to recruit fighters and frame conflict as a holy war against secular governance (Skabash, 2023).*

4. IMPACT OF INSURGENCY AND TERRORISM ON NIGERIA'S NATIONAL SECURITY

- *1. Erosion of Territorial Integrity: Occupation and governance of local areas in Borno, Yobe, and Adamawa states by insurgent groups, setting up alternative administrations that portray the federal government as incapable (Folarin & Oviasogie, n.d.).*
- *2. Humanitarian Crisis (Displacement & Casualties): Thousands killed and millions displaced into IDP camps/refugee status (Dibia, 2021).*
- *3. Economic Consequences and Developmental Setback: Devastates key sectors (agriculture, mining, commerce); farmlands abandoned due to fear, fueling inflation and poverty. Insecurity discourages investors and forces government to divert public development funds to military budgets (Obi, 2021).*

- *4. Overextension of Security Apparatus: Security forces face multi-front battles (Boko Haram in Northeast, banditry in Northwest, separatists in Southeast). Lack of modern technology and coordination overstretches military forces, giving insurgents mobility advantages (Folarin & Oviasogie, n.d.).*
- *5. Threats to Democratic Stability and Governance: States of emergency and militarization of civilian spaces cause human rights abuses and democratic backsliding. Frustration with government inaction fuels radicalization, electoral apathy, and authoritarian tendencies (Obi, 2021).*
- *6. Exacerbation of Ethno-Religious Divides: Terrorist ideologies exploit fault lines, triggering cycles of reprisal attacks and promoting secessionist sentiments. Requires inclusive governance, reconciliation, and deradicalization (Dibia, 2021).*
- *7. Declining International Perception and Diplomatic Challenges: Tarnishes international image, causes travel advisories, reduces foreign investment, and weakens Nigeria's regional diplomatic leverage in Africa (Obi, 2021).*

5. SUMMARY AND POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

Insurgency and terrorism represent two sides of a coin reflecting citizen discontentment against unresponsive governance and selective development. Violent non-state actors exploit local grievances and civilian populations, creating complex existential threats (Ogungbile, 2020).

> ### Three Core Recommendations for Government
>
> 1. ***Holistic Approach Balancing Military Action with Socioeconomic Reform: Invest in military intelligence, training, and ammunition, while recognizing force alone cannot solve the problem. Implement systemic socioeconomic reforms to improve lives.***
> 2. ***Justice and Inclusive Nation-Building: Practice justice, equity, and inclusive development across all sectors and states to address regional/sectoral marginalization and pacify grievances.***
> 3. ***Fight Poverty Through Employment and GDP Growth: Drive job creation, enhance Gross Domestic Product, and improve the general quality of life to match standards in developed nations.***

CHAPTER TEN: INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

By Vincent Obiora Emesibe (Department of Political Science, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. INTRODUCTION & CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS

A. Clarification of Concepts

- **Conflict: Disputes, violent confrontations, and wars between states (inter-state conflicts) or between a state and a rebel group / internal groups within its territory (intra-state conflicts).**
- **Conflict Resolution vs. Conflict Management (Sewell, 1999; Sumita, 2011):**
  - **Conflict Management: Less encompassing; top-down intervention mechanism interested in controlling a conflict rather than addressing root causes (Sumita, 2011).**
  - **Conflict Resolution: Comprehensive, conciliatory approach aiming for peaceful settlement by removing root causes, ending violence, and reaching a mutually accepted negotiated agreement (Ramsbotham, Woodhouse & Miall; Sumita, 2011). Encompasses non-violent measures, conflict termination, and post-conflict peacebuilding.**
- **International Organizations: Institutions comprising membership of governments or non-governmental entities with operations transcending national borders.**
  - **Inter-governmental Organizations (IGOs): Member states are sovereign governments (e.g., UN, AU, ECOWAS).**
  - **Non-governmental Organizations (NGOs): Members are private individuals and civil groups.**

2. THE UNITED NATIONS (UN): KEY ORGANS & MECHANISMS

Established in 1945 following WWII to save succeeding generations from the scourge of war. The UN Charter positions international peace and security as its primary purpose.

A. Key UN Organs in Conflict Resolution

UN Organ	Structure, Key Functions & Specific Role in Peace
Security Council (UNSC)	***Primary responsibility for maintaining international peace and security.*** ***• Composition: 15 members (5 Permanent [P-5] with veto power: USA, Russia, UK, France, China; and 10 Non-permanent members elected every 2 years).*** ***• Functions: Authorizes peacekeeping operations, special political missions, peacebuilding commissions, and imposes sanctions.***
Secretariat	***Headed by the Secretary-General. Administers and manages UN conflict operations via:*** ***• Department of Peace Operations (DPO): Plans, deploys, and manages peacekeeping operations.*** ***• Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs (DPPA): Manages Special Political Missions (SPM) and post-conflict peacebuilding.*** ***• Mediation Support Unit (MSU): Deploys mediators, envoys, and logistical support.***
General Assembly (UNGA)	***Main deliberative organ comprising all member states (1 vote each; loses voting right if dues unpaid for 2 years).*** ***• Approves peace/security budgets.*** ***• Can authorize peace operations when UNSC is deadlocked by veto.*** ***• Appoints Secretary-General and ICJ Judges jointly with UNSC.*** ***• Oversees Special Committee on Peacekeeping Operations (C-34), established in*** *1965* ***.***
International Court of Justice (ICJ)	***Judicial arm of the UN; dispenses arbitration/adjudication over state disputes. Composed of 15 judges elected by UNSC and UNGA for 9-year terms. States need not be UN members to be affected by ICJ decisions.***

B. United Nations Mechanisms for Conflict Resolution

1. ***Conflict Prevention & Mediation (Preventive Diplomacy): Diplomatic actions taken to prevent disputes from escalating into conflict or limiting spread. Uses Peace Envoys, Good Offices of Secretary-General, DPPA, and MSU. UN prefers prevention/avoidance over force.***
2. ***Special Political Missions (SPMs): Civilian-led missions engaged in prevention, mediation, election assistance, rule of law, and human rights monitoring (more than double existing peacekeeping operations).***
3. ***Peacemaking: Reconciliatory tool facilitating negotiated agreements between warring parties (e.g., 2015 UN peacekeeping mission facilitating Malian peace agreement).***
4. ***Peacebuilding: Diplomatic, political, and developmental activities to prevent relapse into conflict. Involves World Bank, IMF, DPPA, and Peacebuilding Commission.***
5. ***Sanctions: Coercive non-violent measures imposed by UNSC (e.g., arms embargoes) to compel compliance.***
   • NATO/Coalition Interventions: UNSC Resolution 1973 (*2011* ***) authorized Libya intervention implemented by NATO. Resolution 2085 (*** *2012* ***) led to France's Operation Serval in Mali.***
6. ***Peacekeeping Operations: Most visible tool deployed following cessation of hostilities.***
   - ***Scope: Includes early peacebuilding (election assistance, DDR — Disarmament, Demobilisation, and Reintegration).***

- ***History: Commenced in 1948 with UN Truce Supervision Organization (UNTSO). The 1956 UN Emergency Force (UNEF I) marked the first lightly armed military deployment during the Suez Crisis.***
- ***Current Scale: 11 active UN peacekeeping operations with ~70,000 personnel worldwide (5 in Africa, including MINURSO in Western Sahara [1991] and MONUSCO in DRC [2010]).***

3. HYBRID SUPPORT MISSIONS

Hybrid Peace Support Missions serve as a cost-saving alternative for conflict resolution, peace, and security operations. While UN peace missions provide cost savings, financial and logistical incapacities have hindered the African Union (AU) and ECOWAS from independently achieving effective conflict resolution in Africa and West Africa.

4. FIVE KEY CHALLENGES FACING INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS (UN, AU, ECOWAS)

Challenge Category	Specific Manifestations & Case Examples
1. Logistics & Financial Constraints	***Contemporary multidimensional integrated operations in hostile environments require massive budgets and high-level logistics that member states and regional bodies struggle to meet, constraining timely deployment.***
2. Complexity of Modern Conflicts	***Contemporary battlefields combine rebels, violent extremists, terrorists, and trans-border criminal syndicates (e.g., in Mali, Somalia, DRC, and Sudan). This results in high peacekeeper fatality rates and strains ECOWAS/UN management.***
3. External & Great Power Interference	***Special interests of major powers frequently obstruct collective resolution (Terrif & Keeley, 2007). For example, France exerted undue influence in the UN stabilization mission in Mali (MINUSMA) before its eventual exit following Mali's military takeover.***
4. Inadequate Institutional Structure	***Bureaucratic complexity and huge decision-making structures hamper rapid deployment. Significantly, the UN lacks its own standing army / stand-by force and depends entirely on Troop Contributing Countries (TCCs).***
5. Deficient UN-Regional Cooperation	***Strained relationships between the UN and regional bodies during transitions. For example, during the Malian conflict (2011 – 2013), friction occurred when transitioning from the African-Led International Support Mission to Mali (AFISMA) to the UN's MINUSMA.***

5. SUMMARY, REFORM INITIATIVES & RECOMMENDATIONS

International organizations continue to assist in saving succeeding generations from the scourge of war through preventive diplomacy, mediation, arms control, and peacekeeping.

Peacekeeping remains the most prominent active tool, while preventive diplomacy and mediation stand as the most preferred mechanism.

> ***Ongoing Reforms & Future Outlook***
>
> - ***UN Secretary-General Reforms: Under Antonio Guterres, the UN peace architecture is undergoing structural reforms across DPPA and DPO, including the launch of A4P (Action for Peacekeeping) to shape people-centred mechanisms focused on human rights protection.***
> - ***Improving Peacekeeper Security: Enhancing safety and legitimacy against high fatality rates.***
> - ***Strengthening AU Capacities: Since approximately 45% of global peacekeeping operations are deployed in Africa, the African Union must enhance its internal financial and logistical capabilities to efficiently partner with the UN.***

CHAPTER ELEVEN: THE MEDIA AND TRADITIONAL INSTITUTIONS IN PEACE BUILDING

By Chiazor Anthonia Chiaghana (Department of Mass Communication, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS & DEFINITIONS

A. The Media

- ***Broad Definition: Channels of communication used to share information, news, and entertainment with a large group cutting across regions and boundaries (Ayodele, 2022). Encompasses traditional (TV, radio, newspapers) and new/digital media.***
- ***Societal & Democratic Role: Watchdog of society and the "fourth estate of the realm" (Khan, 2025). Upholds freedom of expression, freedom of speech, and representation of diverse opinions (Kuusik, 2010).***
- ***Dual Nature in Peace & Conflict: Susceptible to manipulation, propaganda, and causing conflict (Abubakar, 2021), but acts as a signpost and tool for peacebuilding when providing non-partisan, balanced reporting (Spurk, 2002).***

B. Traditional Institutions

- ***Definition: Systems of governance at the grassroots level rooted in established customs, traditions, and cultural practices (Nwosu, 2022 ; Lamai, 2020).***
- ***Examples: Traditional rulers (kings, chiefs), elders, traditional courts, age grades, customary practices, and religious institutions.***
- ***Core Social Function: Form the core moral social fabric of society, shaping norms, maintaining order, and conducting dispute resolution (Lamai, 2020).***

C. Peacebuilding Concept

- ***Core Nature: Peace is not merely the absence of conflict, but the presence of justice, inclusion, and understanding (Connor et al., 2025).***
- ***Kroc Institute Definition (2025): Implementation of measures to create or sustain peace, developing constructive personal, group, and political relationships across ethnic, religious, and racial boundaries.***
- ***Process & Scope (Christofis, 2020 ; Uwem, 2020): Complex process involving multiple actors aimed at preventing or stopping violent conflict. Encompasses conflict prevention, management, resolution, transformation, and post-conflict reconciliation via negotiation, mediation, ADR, and non-violent resistance.***

2. CORE ROLES OF MEDIA IN SOCIETY

Media Function	Key Operational Mechanics & Scholar Citations
1. Information Dissemination	Serves as gatekeepers of information, reporting on political, scientific, and social developments to keep citizens informed during peace and crisis (Murugesan, 2023 ; Okoro, Icha-Ituma & Okunna, 2020).
2. Agenda Setting	Focuses public attention on specific issues by placing emphasis on them, signaling to society what is important to debate and demand action on (MacQuail, 2010).
3. Influence on Public Opinions & Attitudes	Moulds public discourse and societal values by influencing story language, context, and emphasis, shaping collective beliefs and behaviors.

3. SPECIFIC ROLES OF THE MEDIA IN PEACEBUILDING

- Advocate of Human Rights: Journalistic reporting committed to ethical/moral standards acts as an advocate for human rights defenders (Ogbemi, 2020).
- Information Provider (Indirect Activity): Offers non-partisan, balanced, and accurate reporting (Spurk, 2002). Example: During the #ENDSARS protests against police brutality in Nigeria, media informed the public on factual goals to clear misconceptions and lower tension.
- Watchdog & Conflict Prevention: Changes attitudes away from violence (Bratic & Schirch, 2008) and exposes human rights violations. Example: Reporting on the Benue State farmer-herder clashes to attract peaceful intervention (Aondover, Onyejelem & Garba, 2024).
- Diplomat & Bridge Builder: Facilitates dialogue and understanding between conflicting groups (Chiluwa, 2022).
- Changing Attitudes & Behaviours: Promotes tolerance and respect for diversity while challenging negative stereotypes.
- Peace Messaging & Watchdog on Leadership: Factual analysis exposes government shortcomings, educates the public, popularizes peace initiatives, and promotes dialogue (Aho, 2024 ; Mahmud, 2020 ; Mutahar & Rajpals, 2021).

4. COUNTERING DISINFORMATION IN PEACEBUILDING

> **Structural Nature of Disinformation**
>
> Disinformation is structural and systemic—more than just spreading false information, it is produced with intent to harm and then shared widely by individuals who may have no intent to deceive (Marx, 2025). The media's role in fact-checking and spreading accurate narratives is vital to prevent panic and manipulation during crises (Kuusik, 2010).

Multi-Faceted Approach to Countering Disinformation

- Fact-Checking & Accurate Reporting: Gatekeepers' scrutiny to ensure stories gain clearance before publication, preventing false info from inciting fear or violence.

- *Media Literacy: Defined by Okunna and Omenugha (2012) as the ability to sift through and analyze messages that seek to inform, entertain, and educate. Essential in combating fake news during sensitive conflicts (Edcani & Edcani, 2021).*
- *Social Media Moderation: Countering fake news and threat narratives to bolster peace messaging (Witting & Ghoshch, 2020).*
- *Collaboration & Partnership: Joint conflict analysis between media and government to uncover root causes and facilitate mediation.*
- *Promoting Respectful Online Dialogue: Preventing social media polarization and echo chambers (Okocha, Akpe & Odeba, 2024).*
- *Independence & Freedom of Expression: Effective countering requires freedom from censorship. Government interference undermines media credibility and accurate reporting.*

5. TRADITIONAL INSTITUTIONS IN PEACE MESSAGING & DISPUTE SETTLEMENT

Traditional institutions are a vital cog in communal peaceful coexistence, demanding the use of community beliefs, morals, procedures, and cultural practices (Mbwirire & Kurwa, 2018). Chiefs and councils of elders act as custodians of peace (Momoh, 2021).

A. Roles of Traditional Rulers

- *Mediation & Arbitration: High reputation and respect enable traditional rulers to arrange peacemaking meetings and rebuild cordial relationships against violence.*
- *Community Leadership: Possess wisdom to navigate complex community negotiations in both violent and non-violent conflicts (Mboh, 2022).*
- *Reconciliation & Restoration: Focus on healing relationships and restoring social harmony rather than mere punitive measures.*

B. Family Structure (Family Members / Siblings)

- *Initial Dispute Resolution: Mediating family disputes by inviting trusted family friends to resolve issues internally and avoid court escalation.*
- *Extended Family (Kinsmen / Kindred Women — Umuada & Umunna): In Igbo culture, unresolved or extreme disputes are elevated to Umuada (patrilineal daughters) and Umunna (patrilineal kinsmen) for collective decision-making.*

C. Community Elders

- *Wise Council: Revered for their wisdom and experience in dispute resolution.*
- *Mediation & Advice: Act as unbiased mediators providing impartial guidance and advice (without offering formal legal advice) to resolve existing disputes.*

Chapter 11 Conclusion

Both the media (as the fourth estate and information gatekeeper) and traditional institutions (as the core moral social fabric) are indispensable forces in peacebuilding. While the media influences public discourse and counters disinformation, traditional rulers, elders, Umuada, and Umunna utilize time-tested customary mechanisms to heal relationships and foster durable grassroots peace.

CHAPTER TWELVE: MANAGING POST-CONFLICT SITUATIONS

By Austin Ntol Inyamigim (Department of Philosophy, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka)

1. INTRODUCTION & KEY STAKEHOLDERS

Post-conflict situations represent a critical phase in the aftermath of armed conflict, characterized by the need for humanitarian assistance, stabilization, and recovery. These scenarios lead to significant displacement, affecting refugees and internally displaced persons (IDPs) (UNHCR, 2021).

Key Stakeholders in Post-Conflict Recovery

- ***UN-OCHA (United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs): Orchestrates humanitarian efforts to ensure aid reaches those most in need.***
- ***Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs): Provide direct assistance, advocate for displaced populations, and foster community resilience.***
- ***Local Community Leaders: Bridge the gap between international humanitarian efforts and affected populations using unique local knowledge.***
- ***International Criminal Court (ICC): Established in 2002 to address impunity for atrocities and war crimes in post-conflict societies, strengthening justice and human rights (IDMC, 2021).***

2. FEATURES OF POST-CONFLICT SITUATIONS

Post-conflict environments are often characterized by protracted crises (e.g., Syrian Civil War, South Sudan, Yemen) where recovery is hindered by ongoing violence and instability.

- ***Humanitarian Crises & Dual Displacement: Triggers immediate needs for both refugees (who cross international borders) and IDPs (who remain within national borders) (IDMC, 2021).***
- ***Economic Instability: Destruction of infrastructure, loss of livelihoods, high unemployment rates, and inflation (World Bank, 2020).***
- ***Social Fragmentation: Erosion of community trust due to trauma and violence, necessitating relationship rebuilding (Fischer, 2019).***

3. THE REFUGEE CRISIS

> ### *Legal Definition of a Refugee (1951 Convention)*
>
> ***Article 1 of the 1951 Convention: Defines a refugee as someone who "owing to well-founded fear of being persecuted for reasons of race, religion, nationality, membership of a particular social group or political opinion, is outside the country of [their] nationality and is unable or, owing to such fear, is unwilling to avail [themselves] of the protection of that country..." (UNHCR, 2001–2002).***

- *Causes of Refugee Crises: Prolonged armed conflict (UNHCR, 2022), systematic persecution (Smith, 2021), and environmental/natural disasters (IDMC, 2021).*
- *Challenges Faced by Refugees: Barriers to basic services (healthcare, education, shelter; Benson & O'Neill, 2020), legal protection and bureaucratic asylum procedures (UNHCR, 2022), and severe psychological trauma requiring mental health support (Morris, 2022).*
- *Host Country Implications: Resource strain, social tension between refugees and locals, and integration demands (Smith, 2021).*

4. INTERNALLY DISPLACED PERSONS (IDPS) & LEGAL FRAMEWORKS

Definition & Unique Challenges

IDPs: Persons forced to flee their homes due to armed conflict, violence, or disasters who have not crossed an internationally recognized state border (UNHCR, 2022).

- *Lack of International Protections: Unlike refugees, IDPs remain under national laws and lack dedicated international legal conventions, leaving them vulnerable to neglect (IDMC, 2021).*
- *Prolonged Displacement: Extended displacement traps IDPs in chronic poverty and dependency (Morris, 2022).*
- *Access to Basic Needs & Psychosocial Effects: Overcrowded camps, poor sanitation, disease risks, anxiety, depression, and PTSD (Benson & O'Neill, 2020 ; Smith, 2021).*

Eight Components of the Legal & Policy Framework for IDPs

Framework Pillar	Core Provisions, Mechanics & Citations
1. UN Guiding Principles (1998)	Developed in 1998 as the foundational framework for IDP protection, outlining rights to protection against displacement, humanitarian assistance, and participation in return/resettlement decisions (UNHCR, 2022 ; IDMC, 2021).
2. National Legal Frameworks	Adopting specific national laws explicitly defining IDP rights and government responsibilities for immediate and long-term recovery (Morris, 2022 ; Benson & O'Neill, 2020).
3. Policy Integration	Embedding IDP protection into broader national disaster management plans and human rights frameworks (Smith, 2021 ; UNHCR, 2022).
4. Capacity Building for Officials	Training programs on IDP rights, legal standards, and best coordination practices for government and local authorities (Morris, 2022 ; Benson & O'Neill, 2020).
5. Civil Society Engagement	Partnering with NGOs and CBOs for policy insights, advocacy, and government accountability (IDMC, 2021 ; Smith, 2021).
6. Monitoring & Reporting	Regular assessments and collecting disaggregated data to identify gaps and enable targeted interventions (UN-OCHA, 2021 ; IDMC, 2021).
7. Promoting Access to Justice	Establishing legal aid programs and disseminating legal rights information to empower IDPs to seek redress (Morris, 2022 ; Benson & O'Neill, 2020).
8. International Cooperation	Receiving technical assistance from UNHCR and IOM (International Organization for Migration), alongside best practice sharing across nations (IDMC, 2021 ; UNHCR, 2022).

5. ROLE OF INSTITUTIONAL ACTORS IN POST-CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

A. Role of UN-OCHA

- Core Primary Responsibility: Harmonization and coordination of humanitarian efforts to avoid aid duplication and fill service delivery gaps. Serves as a central hub for information sharing.
- Resource Mobilization: Leads international funding appeals to donor countries to sustain long-term operations in resource-constrained environments.
- Data Collection & Evidence-Based Intervention: Conducts needs assessments to gather data on evolving landscapes, ensuring aid targets pressing refugee and IDP needs.
- Promoting Humanitarian Principles: Advocates for civilian protection and adherence to International Humanitarian Law (IHL), preserving dignity and rights.
- Facilitating Aid Access & Local Inclusion: Engages governments and armed groups to negotiate aid access in volatile zones while strengthening local organization capacities for sustainable recovery.

B. Role of Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)

- **Direct Essential Service Delivery: Fills critical gaps by providing food, clean water, shelter, and medical care (e.g., Doctors Without Borders / Médecins Sans Frontières addressing urgent health crises and preventing disease outbreaks; Benson & O'Neill, 2020).**
- **Education & Psychosocial Support: Implements informal education, vocational training, and trauma counseling for youth/children to restore normalcy (Smith, 2021).**
- **Advocacy & Local Capacity Building: Raises global awareness for refugee/IDP rights, lobbies governments, trains local communities in healthcare/sanitation/conflict resolution, and monitors program effectiveness (Morris, 2022 ; IDMC, 2021).**
- **Operational Challenges: Security risks, funding shortfalls, bureaucratic obstacles, and political resistance in conflict zones (Smith, 2021).**

C. Role of Community Leaders

- **Grassroots Intermediaries: Bridge communication and trust gaps between displaced individuals, external NGOs, and international agencies (Khan, 2020).**
- **Mediation & Social Cohesion: Resolve lingering local disputes, foster dialogue, promote reconciliation, and prevent violence re-emergence (Fischer, 2019).**
- **Resource Mobilization & Culturally Appropriate Interventions: Galvanize local volunteerism and knowledge-sharing while ensuring aid aligns with local customs and traditions (Morris, 2022 ; Adams, 2021).**

6. MAJOR CHALLENGES IN MANAGING POST-CONFLICT SITUATIONS

Challenge Category	Specific Manifestations & Impacts on Recovery
1. Security Instability	**Ongoing violence, political unrest, or armed groups threaten aid workers and restrict access to vulnerable populations, deterring IDPs/refugees from returning home (Khan, 2020).**
2. Funding Shortfalls & Resource Scarcity	**Reliance on donor contributions often leads to insufficient funds, forcing aid agencies to prioritize certain urgent needs over others and delaying infrastructure rebuilding (Benson & O'Neill, 2020).**
3. Fragmentation of Humanitarian Efforts	**Lack of synergy among numerous NGOs, local groups, and UN agencies leads to coordination inefficiencies, service overlaps, and delivery gaps (UN-OCHA, 2021).**
4. Cultural & Social Barriers	**Deep-seated social divisions, historical grievances, and community mistrust undermine collaborative peacebuilding and social cohesion (Fischer, 2019).**
5. Psychosocial Impact & Trauma	**Widespread trauma, grief, and mental health issues (PTSD) severely hinder individuals' capacity to actively participate in community recovery efforts (Morris, 2022).**
6. Political Obstacles & Governance Failure	**Political instability, corrupt government resistance, politicized aid distribution, and bureaucratic delays severely hinder program implementation (Smith, 2021).**

Chapter 12 & Full Course Final Conclusion

Managing post-conflict situations is a complex, multi-dimensional endeavor that requires coordinated efforts across global institutions (UN-OCHA, UNHCR, ICC), non-governmental organizations, and local community leaders. Achieving sustainable peace and recovery demands addressing not only immediate physical and economic needs, but also restoring social cohesion, ensuring legal protection, providing mental health support, and upholding justice across affected populations.

7. COMPREHENSIVE CONCLUSION: MANAGING POST-CONFLICT SITUATIONS

The aftermath of armed conflict presents massive humanitarian challenges, requiring the coordinated efforts of international organizations, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), community leaders, and local populations to handle refugee needs, IDP settlement, infrastructure restoration, and social cohesion.

Core Takeaways for Successful Post-Conflict Recovery

- ***UN-OCHA's Pivotal Coordination Role: Ensures effective aid coordination and resource mobilization while promoting adherence to humanitarian principles that protect human rights and dignity.***
- ***Indispensable Contribution of NGOs: Deliver immediate assistance, operate independently to address critical needs of marginalized groups, and build local capacities.***
- ***Vital Influence of Community Leaders: Facilitate communication, resolve conflicts, and mobilize community resources. Their local knowledge and influence remain vital for fostering trust and social cohesion.***
- ***Holistic and Collaborative Strategy: Successfully managing post-conflict situations requires tackling interrelated challenges—such as security instability, funding limitations, fragmentation of efforts, cultural barriers, and political obstacles—through inclusive collaboration and resilience-building.***